

How We Have a Cum-Worthy September

Joe + Ryan's September roadmap

SEPTEMBER 7–30, 2026 · REVISED FROM OUR WORKING SESSION

September exit conditions

Four outcomes to organize the month around.

01 / Astir 001	The first event is locked internally: a confirmed date, venue, required people, equipment, logistics and a promotion plan with enough lead time.
02 / 30 friends	Thirty friends have the beta and can open it. The rebrand and a clear event experience meet the agreed release conditions.
03 / Brand	Our social presence and website are live. A shared system keeps publishing content, the first newsletter is ready, and the mailing list works.
04 / Rachel	Rachel has access, tools and an agreed role. She can produce content and advance the event components she chooses to own.

September closes with evidence for each outcome. The event date can fall in October.

The order that makes this possible

Early work removes the dependencies that would otherwise consume the month.

First / Enable	Bring Rachel in immediately. Agree her availability and interests, provide brand assets and tools, and start the shared workspaces.
Then / Establish	Start publishing in Week 1. Build the website and mailing list while researching event feasibility and writing the app’s event spec.
Next / Commit	Choose an event after checking its constraints. Build and test the app experience, gather early feedback, and expand toward 30 friends.
Finally / Close	Secure event commitments, resolve release blockers, and prove the publishing process works repeatedly with multiple contributors.

Proposed dates depend on the Sep 11 scope review. Preserve promotion lead time when choosing the event date.

The four objectives

01 / Astir 001 locked internally

We know exactly what will happen, who will make it happen and when.

Event discovery	Hold an event-planning session. Map the work, outside dependencies, costs and likely lead times before promising a date.
Concept choice	Develop the top two or three concepts. Compare audience, format, cost and complexity. Select a primary concept and a viable backup.
Date + commitments	Confirm venue access, required labor or vendors, equipment and logistics for one date. Record each commitment and unresolved condition.
Promotion plan	Prepare the story, assets, channels, registration route and release calendar. Agree both brand-establishment time and event-promotion time.
App relationship	Define how 001 appears in the app and where registration happens. Resolve that dependency jointly with Objective 02.

EXIT: an approved event brief and commitment record. Public promotion begins when the team agrees the event is ready.

The shared event workspace

One event record, visible and editable by everyone doing the work.

Brief + boundaries	Audience, experience, date options, geography, capacity, budget limit and what makes an opportunity worth pursuing.
Work breakdown	Venue, labor/vendors, equipment, logistics, promotion, registration and app integration. Each component has one accountable owner.
Current state	Track not started, contacting, awaiting reply, held, confirmed or blocked. Keep tentative holds distinct from confirmed bookings.
Action + evidence	Each item includes contact, quote or terms, due date, next action, dependency and a link to the commitment or decision.
Rachel's authority	After the role conversation, give her selected components and outreach criteria. Agree what she can decide and which commitments need founder input.

EXIT: every required component has an owner and a status. Any remaining blocker is visible before the date is called locked.

02 / The 30-friends beta

The gate measures people with access to a usable app. Feedback guides the next release.

Baseline + rebrand	Review search together against agreed tasks. Finish the rebrand and verify the baseline flows. The latest search changes still need acceptance.
Event experience	Deliver a clear event hub/tab and a coherent home for 001. Define the smallest version that protects the first impression.
Release conditions	Triage existing issues this week, define P0/P1 severity and fix release blockers. Check map performance on the candidate build.
Friends + feedback	Prepare a named roster and invite route. Collect the 30-question survey after use, hold follow-up meetings, and turn findings into prioritized fixes.
Gate measurement	Count distinct friends who receive the beta and successfully open it. Track feedback and use separately. Confirm the exact gate in Week 1.

EXIT: 30 verified friends with working access, a release that passes the agreed checklist, and a running survey, meeting and feedback process.

The full development scope

Objective 02 includes new work, release quality and changes learned from users.

Search acceptance	Joe + Ryan try the latest search together. Agree representative tasks, record gaps and distinguish acceptable beta quality from later improvements.
P0/P1 triage	Review existing bugs this week. Proposed P0: a critical flow is unusable or data is at risk. P1: a core task fails with no reasonable workaround.
Map performance	Verify the recent performance work on target devices and representative maps. Record slowdowns and regressions against agreed acceptance criteria.
Events + opt-in	Build the approved event experience and newsletter signup integration. Carry the app rebrand and any remaining baseline gaps in the same estimate.
Feedback fixes	Reserve recurring development blocks for survey and interview findings. Implement the highest-impact changes and retest them with users.

RELEASE GATE: accepted search and map behavior, agreed event scope, no open P0/P1 release blockers and tested feedback fixes.

Survey + follow-up meetings

Objective 02 includes a repeatable way to learn from the people using the app.

Before rollout	Pilot the 30-question Google Form with two testers. Name the collection owner, link the response sheet and check the time to complete.
After use	Send after a meaningful session or failed first attempt, ideally within 24–48 hours. Send one reminder after three days if needed.
Follow-up meetings	Offer a 20-minute conversation to willing respondents. Proposal: 8–10 meetings across the cohort, including blocked and successful users.
From answer to fix	Review responses daily. Record the task, expected result, actual result and impact. Turn actionable findings into owned issues.
Close the loop	Review themes weekly, verify fixes with testers and record retest outcomes. Track survey and meeting status separately from the 30-friends gate.

EXIT: a working form, response tracker, completed user conversations and a prioritized backlog with evidence.

The event feature needs a crisp spec

Joe + Ryan settle the product relationship before committing to a build date.

Experience	Define how someone discovers 001, understands it, opens details and registers. Specify upcoming, unavailable and empty states.
Model + navigation	Define event versus place, the relationship to the map, and where the event hub lives. Record any new data model or migration work.
Scope decision	Compare a minimal event hub with fuller integration. A place-profile shortcut or external form remains an option to evaluate.
Acceptance + tests	Test navigation, event details, registration handoff, map/place relationships and failure states. Include regression coverage for the existing app.
Release review	Run a joint walkthrough and user feedback session. Record pass/fail against the spec before increasing the friend cohort.

PROPOSED DEFAULT: include an event hub in the 30-friends release. Change that condition only through an explicit product decision.

03 / Brand presence + a publishing system

An established public presence and a process that keeps producing.

Identity + accounts	Align the app icon, social avatars, bios and voice with the rebrand. Set up Instagram and TikTok access and profile destinations.
Website	Launch the redesigned domain with a clear brand story and mailing-list signup. Add public event information once it is ready.
Mailing list	Connect website and app signup to the list. Build optional account-creation opt-in in REC-449 and test the subscriber flow.
Newsletter	Create the first complete issue, reusable format and editorial plan. Test delivery internally. Choose a public send date separately.
Publishing system	Create shared asset intake, ideas, drafts, review and scheduling. Multiple contributors can move work forward with clear ownership.

EXIT: live profiles and site, a working list, published content, a complete first newsletter and a repeatable editorial process.

App signup + the mailing list

A shared development dependency for Objective 02 and Objective 03.

Signup choice	An optional, unchecked newsletter checkbox appears during account creation. People can continue without subscribing.
Data + delivery	Save the user’s choice and sync explicit opt-ins to the mailing list. Test opt-in, opt-out, retries and failure handling.
One audience	Website signup and app signup feed the same agreed audience model. Existing unsubscribe choices remain respected.
Newsletter milestone	Create the complete first newsletter and test delivery internally. Public launch timing remains a separate editorial decision.

TRACKED IN LINEAR: [REC-449 / Optional newsletter opt-in during account creation](#)

The content workflow

A proposed cadence to test with Rachel. Post counts below are cumulative.

Shared inputs	Pool existing photos, footage, references and ideas. Give contributors brand guidance and reusable templates from the start.
Editorial session	Joe + Ryan sketch the workflow, then shape it with Rachel. Agree topics, quality bar, review turnaround and who can publish.
One shared queue	Each item records the idea, assets, creator, reviewer, channel, publish date and status. Save the live link after publication.
Scheduler	Choose and configure an existing scheduler unless a specific unmet need justifies building one. Verify account access and a scheduled test post.
September proposal	Publish 15 original pieces: one each weekday from Sep 10–30. Create newsletter #1 by Sep 18, then review and rehearse delivery by Sep 25. Cross-posts do not add to the 15.

EXIT: contributors complete the workflow repeatedly, with the next week queued. Confirm or revise cadence with Rachel on Sep 9.

04 / Rachel is plugged in

Week 1 is an onboarding sprint. By Sep 11, she moves into ongoing production.

Role conversation	Ask about her interests, capacity and experience, especially events. Agree expectations and working arrangements before assigning the workload.
Access	Provide Slack, the shared boards, brand assets or relevant repo access, social accounts and the content publishing workflow.
Tools + practice	Review the AI tools she already has. Supply a starter toolkit, a short working session and any agreed subscriptions or support.
Content ownership	Give her usable assets and room to create. Complete one draft-to-publish cycle together, then agree when she can publish independently.
Event ownership	Share the event boundaries and work breakdown. Let her choose components, such as venue outreach, with authority and next steps made explicit.

EXIT: By Sep 11: access, tooling, a full content cycle and agreed event ownership. Finish any residual setup by Sep 15.

The month

Four weekly gates

Proposed workback. The Sep 11 review sets a realistic development forecast.

Objective	Sep 7–13 Set up + start	Sep 14–20 Build + validate	Sep 21–27 Commit + expand	Sep 28–30 Close + continue
001	Research planning. Compare 2–3 concepts. Start outreach.	Select concept. Check date, venue, people and equipment.	Secure commitments and complete promotion plan.	Verify the internal lock and announce only when ready.
App + friends	Triage P0/P1s. Accept search. Check map performance. Spec events and opt-in. Pilot survey.	Build events and opt-in, fix blockers, collect first surveys and book follow- ups.	Develop feedback fixes, test the release and expand toward 30 when ready.	Verify 30 working installs and close critical gaps.
Brand	Profiles, site and list. Start the queue. 2 posts proposed	Repeat production. Create newsletter #1. 7 posts cumulative	Keep publishing. Review newsletter and test delivery. 12 posts cumulative	Finish September and queue October. 15 posts cumulative
Rachel	Sprint: role, access, tools, first content cycle and chosen event tasks by Sep 11.	Produce content, build assets and advance owned event tasks. Residual setup ends Sep 15.	Produce and publish independently. Advance event work and refine the process.	Deliver content and event work. Queue October’s production.

Sep 7–13 / Set up + start

A = first focus block. B = second focus block. Weekend work is optional buffer.

MON Sep 7	TUE Sep 8	WED Sep 9	THU Sep 10	FRI Sep 11	SAT Sep 12	SUN Sep 13
Working session Use this discussion to settle the four outcomes and record open decisions. Plan Prepare the first joint sessions and the shared work list.	A / Rachel Meet on interests, capacity and role. Supply access and existing assets. B / Foundations Split: app lead triages existing bugs; event lead maps planning. Draft content workflow.	A / Product spec Joint search acceptance. App lead defines event scope and newsletter opt-in. B / Editorial Train Rachel on tools and workflow. Choose scheduler and first pieces.	A / Event options Event lead checks 2–3 concepts. App lead fixes triaged blockers. B / Brand build Rachel completes a content cycle. Finish site/list setup. Publish piece 1.	A / Scope gate Review P0/P1s, search, map performance and scope. Pilot survey. Forecast release. B / Brand launch Test site/list. Confirm Rachel's owned work. Publish piece 2.	Optional buffer Use only for slipped setup work or creative asset gathering.	Optional reset Review replies and prepare Monday's work if useful.
OUTPUT Four outcomes captured.	OUTPUT Owners + shared boards.	OUTPUT Spec draft + content queue.	OUTPUT Shortlist + first live post.	OUTPUT Forecast + live brand links.	OUTPUT No required milestone.	OUTPUT Next week ready.

Sep 14–20 / Build + validate

App and event leads work in parallel. The content owner runs the agreed daily queue.

MON Sep 14	TUE Sep 15	WED Sep 16	THU Sep 17	FRI Sep 18	SAT Sep 19	SUN Sep 20
A / Build App: events, opt-in and P0/P1 fixes. Event lead resolves shortlist gaps. B / Editorial Batch the week's assets and copy. Publish piece 3.	A / Event choice Choose concept and backup from feasibility evidence. B / Production Continue app build and bug fixes. Rachel advances production. Publish piece 4.	A / App review Walk the event flow, search and map. Review P0/P1 fixes against acceptance. B / Commitments Confirm labor and equipment needs. Publish piece 5.	A / Testing Test app, performance and opt-in. Prepare surveys and meeting slots. B / Newsletter Complete issue 1 and test delivery internally. Publish piece 6.	A / Release gate Review quality. Invite first friends if ready, then survey after meaningful use. B / Weekly proof First newsletter ready. Publish piece 7. Review event commitments.	Optional buffer Handle replies or release support if needed.	Optional reset Check the coming week's queue and availability.
OUTPUT Build slice + weekly queue.	OUTPUT Concept + date candidates.	OUTPUT Issue list + event gaps.	OUTPUT Test results + email ready.	OUTPUT Go/no-go + seven posts.	OUTPUT No required milestone.	OUTPUT No required milestone.

Sep 21–27 / Commit + expand

Expansion follows release readiness. Event promotion follows the agreed launch conditions.

MON Sep 21	TUE Sep 22	WED Sep 23	THU Sep 24	FRI Sep 25	SAT Sep 26	SUN Sep 27
A / Feedback Review surveys and meet users. Build the highest-impact feedback fixes. B / Commitments Close date and venue dependencies. Publish piece 8.	A / Event lock Confirm required people, equipment and logistics for the date. B / Publishing Publish piece 9. Hold user meetings and turn evidence into app issues.	A / Promotion Review event assets, signup route and lead-time calendar. B / App check Retest feedback fixes and map performance. Review opt-in. Publish piece 10.	A / Gap close Build remaining P0/P1 and feedback fixes. Event lead closes commitments. B / Newsletter Revise issue 1 from review. Prepare next content queue. Publish piece 11.	A / Weekly gate Review internal event lock and progress toward 30 friends. B / Brand proof Newsletter rehearsal complete. Publish piece 12. Review feedback themes.	Optional buffer Handle time-sensitive replies or beta support.	Optional reset Prepare the final three-day gap list.
OUTPUT Friend roster + venue state.	OUTPUT Commitment evidence.	OUTPUT Promotion plan + feedback.	OUTPUT Named gap list.	OUTPUT Lock status + twelve posts.	OUTPUT No required milestone.	OUTPUT Owners for remaining gaps.

Sep 28–30 / Close September

Finish the agreed outcomes and leave October ready to run.

MON / SEP 28	TUE / SEP 29	WED / SEP 30
A / Event + app gaps Close outstanding event commitments. Verify beta access person by person and resolve critical issues. B / Content Publish piece 13. Rachel advances owned event work and October assets. Output Final gap list with accountable owners.	A / Full walkthrough Review event readiness, the friend roster and the website-to-mailing-list journey. B / October queue Publish piece 14. Schedule next week and finalize the newsletter package. Output Proof links and a continuing publishing calendar.	A / Exit review Check all four outcomes. Record what shipped, remaining gaps and the decisions those gaps require. B / Next month Publish piece 15. Agree event announcement timing and the next app priorities. Output September results and October owners.

How we run the work

Focus blocks + accountable owners

Proposed working rhythm. Assign the app lead and event lead on Sep 8.

Founder capacity	Proposal: ten two-hour blocks per founder each week. Joint sessions count against both people's capacity.
Parallel work	The app lead covers events, search, P0/P1s, performance, opt-in and feedback fixes. The event lead carries planning and commitments.
Rachel's capacity	Front-load setup into Week 1. From Week 2, Rachel produces content and advances agreed event tasks within her availability.
Protected capacity	Protect two app-lead blocks for feedback fixes and one buffer block each week. Schedule named work into the remaining seven blocks.
Friday review	Open the work itself: build, event commitments, published links and subscriber flow. Reassign or reschedule any work without a credible path.

Day blocks are proposed focus windows, not calendar bookings. Print the daily sheet before work. Joint decisions need both founders; execution needs one owner.

Decisions that control the schedule

Resolve these early enough to change the plan while time remains.

Sep 8 / Ownership	Name the app and event leads. Agree Rachel’s role, availability, access and which event decisions she can make.
Sep 9 / Brand cadence	Confirm channels, post frequency, newsletter format and the shared workflow. The 15-post plan is a starting proposal. Newsletter success means first issue created.
Sep 11 / App scope	Estimate all app work: events, search gaps, P0/P1s, performance and opt-in. Keep feedback capacity free. Reduce scope or revise dates if it exceeds capacity.
Before event lock	Confirm brand-establishment and promotion lead times. Move the event date if commitments or readiness cannot support them.
If capacity tightens	Reduce optional event-feature scope and production complexity. Keep P0/P1 and feedback capacity protected. Reassign work if Rachel’s capacity is lower.

A partial event page, tentative venue hold or unfinished feature stays visibly incomplete until its acceptance conditions pass.

The September 30 review

Four outcomes. The evidence makes the result clear.

001 locked	Open the event brief, confirmed date, venue and required commitments. Review the promotion calendar and app dependency.
30 friends	Reconcile 30 distinct friends with working beta access. Open the release checklist, survey responses, meeting notes and prioritized feedback backlog.
Brand running	Open the social profiles, website, signup flow, published posts, completed newsletter, internal delivery test and the next scheduled queue.
Rachel enabled	Review her agreed role, completed work and access. Confirm she can advance owned work without waiting for founders to supply every input.

Success leaves us with a credible first event, a beta in friends’ hands, a functioning brand presence and a team ready to keep going.